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1. # Lookup

The lookup function is used to search for a value in a one row or one column and return a corresponding value from another row or column.

In simple words it helps us find information from a dataset.

Syntax: =Lookup(lookup_value, lookup_vector, [result_vector])

lookup_value : The value we want to search for means it is a single value, which is provided as a reference

lookup_vector : means the lookup_value's entire row or column

result_vector : The result value which we want from entire row or column

	J	K	L
Ex : 1	Employee code	Employee name	city
2	1	JP kumar	Mumbai
3	2	Anjali Thakur	Delhi
4	9	Arjun jain	Mumbai
5	13	Anupam	Mysor
6	17	Satish	Mumbai
7	20	Manish	Noida

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Here, only employee code is given we have to find out the emp name and city from the main table.

=Lookup (J2, $A$2:$A$21, $B$2:$B$21) = Emp name

=Lookup (J2, $A$2:$A$21, $D$2:$D$21) = city

The lookup_value should not contain any formulas

Disadvantage

- Lookup generally expects the lookup vector to be sorted in ascending order
- It can return an approximate match, so it may not be suitable for every exact-match search.
- It generally requires stored data for reliable results.
- It is less flexible when searching across complex datasets.
- It can be confusing when the lookup and result ranges are not aligned correctly

2. VLOOKUP

This is called as vertical lookups. It searchs for a value in the first column of the table and returns a related value from another

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column in the same table. This looks for a value in the leftmost column of a table and then returns a value in the same row from a column we specify. By default, the table must be sorted in an ascending order.

Syntax: =VLOOKUP (~~lookup~~ lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])

table_array: the whole table

col_index_num: The column number in the selected table from which we want the result

[range_lookup]: specifies the type of match

- FALSE - exact match (0)
- TRUE - approximate match (1)

Ex: =vlookup ($J2, $A$2:$A$21, MATCH (K$1, $A$1:$G$1, 0), 0)

MATCH: used to find the position of a specific value within a row or column. It returns the position number not the actual value

Syntax: =MATCH (lookup_value, lookup_array, match_type)

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lookup_value : The value which we want to find

lookup_array : The lookup_value row or column where excel searches for the value

match type : the exact match or approximate match.

=MATCH (K1, A1:G1, 0)

OIP = 2

~~If~~ Vlookup needs a column number to know which column to return. Instead of manually entering 2, 3 or 4, we use MATCH to find the column number automatically from the heading.

Disadvantage

- The lookup value must be in the first column of the selected table, and the result must be in a column to its right.
- Exact match should be specified
- It returns the first matching results, not all matching records.
- Repeated VLOOKUP formulas across large datasets can slow down a workbook

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